



Founder Doris Wanjiku

COMPANY SNAPSHOT

Ownership

Women-owned leather brand

Location

Nairobi, Kenya

Sector

Leather goods & fashion accessories

Business model

Design-led production with outsourced specialist cutting, stitching and assembly

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

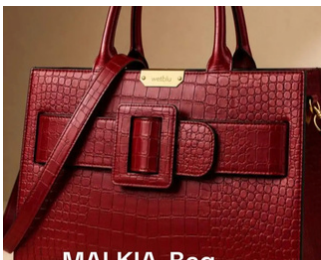
WetBlu by Misshiks is a Kenyan women-owned leather brand creating premium, functional leather bags and accessories designed to last. The brand combines practical everyday utility with understated luxury, African identity and contemporary design.

WetBlu's product philosophy is built around **durability, timeless style and statement value**—pieces intended to be used for years rather than replaced to match every outfit. The business is building a lean value-addition model in which specialist production is outsourced while WetBlu retains control of product design, specifications, quality direction, branding, customer experience and market development.

WHY WETBLU STANDS OUT

- **Design-led Kenyan leather products** with a distinctive African story.
- **Premium positioning** focused on quality-conscious customers.
- **Functional design** for work, travel, lifestyle and gifting.
- **Lean production model** suitable for controlled scaling.
- **Waste-reduction opportunity** through productive use of leather offcuts.
- **Regional ambition** with East African and wider African market development.

Lifestyle bags



Travel bags



Corporate bags



Gifting



CREATING VALUE THROUGH LEATHER

“Statement leather pieces that connect class, function and African heritage.”

OUR STORY

WetBlu was born from a practical need: a durable, stylish bag that could serve the owner for the long term without requiring a different bag for every outfit. That personal need evolved into a design-led leather business built around the belief that leather products should be functional, distinctive and worth keeping.

Today, WetBlu is developing a portfolio of premium bags and accessories inspired by African identity, places, women, heritage and contemporary urban life. The brand's ambition is to take Kenyan craftsmanship and value-added leather products beyond the local market while building a disciplined, scalable operating model.

MISSION

To create premium, functional leather pieces that combine durability, thoughtful design and African identity while creating value through local leather value addition.

VISION

To build a respected African leather brand with a strong Kenyan foundation and growing regional and global market presence.

OUR PRODUCT PORTFOLIO

WORK & EXECUTIVE

Malkia, Commander, laptop sleeves and professional bags

EVERYDAY & LIFESTYLE

Slinger, Binti, SiRi and other compact statement pieces

TRAVEL

Kifaru/Safari and Nyika duffels for travel and utility

ACCESSORIES

Eyewear cases, leather earrings and other small leather goods

FOOTWEAR

Leather sandals and selected lifestyle pieces

HOW WE OPERATE

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEATHER & MATERIALS	DESIGN / SPECS	SPECIALIST PRODUCTION	QUALITY CONTROL	BRANDING & PACKAGING	DIRECT / B2B SALES

OUR MARKET

- Kenya: premium individual customers, gifting, corporate and event opportunities.
- East Africa: Rwanda and other regional markets through fairs, partnerships and digital channels.
- Africa & global: longer-term AfCFTA/export-led market development.

COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGE

- Authentic leather + African storytelling
- Design differentiation rather than commodity pricing
- Lean, scalable outsourced production
- Direct customer relationships through social commerce and events
- Potential circular-economy use of production offcuts

LEADERSHIP

Doris Wanjiku

Founder & Brand Lead

Founder-led business with hands-on oversight across operations, product direction, marketing, PR, finance coordination, customer experience and market development.

OPERATING MODEL

WetBlu currently uses a lean specialist network for cutting, stitching and assembly. This reduces fixed overhead while the brand develops the systems, tooling and quality controls required for a more controlled atelier capability.

WETBLU'S CORE MARKET CHALLENGE

IDENTIFYING OUR IDEAL CUSTOMER — AND REACHING THEM EFFECTIVELY.

WetBlu's key growth challenge is clearly identifying the customer segments that value our products most, understanding their needs, preferences and buying behaviour, and determining the most effective channels and messages to reach and convert them. Stronger customer insight will help WetBlu sharpen product-market fit, pricing, positioning and marketing investment as the brand scales in Kenya and into regional markets.

SUPPORT SOUGHT: Market research • Customer segmentation • Validation • Pricing • Channel strategy • Digital marketing

KENYA LEATHER SECTOR — WHY VALUE ADDITION MATTERS

Kenya's leather sector is being positioned for greater value addition and finished-product manufacturing. Government and sector sources describe a shift from raw and semi-processed leather toward finished goods such as footwear and leather products. The Ministry of Planning reported **35,830 jobs** in the leather value chain in FY2024/25 and **KSh 2.134 billion** in leather and leather-product exports for that period. KIRDI notes that about **89%** of Kenya's leather exports were low-value, partially processed wet-blue leather in 2023, underscoring the opportunity associated with further value addition.

Sources: Kenya Ministry of Planning, Annual Progress Report FY2024/25; Kenya Leather Development Council; KIRDI Industrial Materials Research Centre. Sector figures are national industry statistics and should not be presented as WetBlu's own performance.

2026–2028 STRATEGIC PRIORITIES

01	Strengthen the product portfolio	Refine hero products, sizing, specifications, costing and quality standards.
02	Build controlled production capability	Invest selectively in an efficient minimum atelier and common-use tools while retaining specialist outsourcing where economical.
03	Grow digital sales	Strengthen Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp and direct customer conversion systems.
04	Expand regional markets	Use trade fairs, partnerships and AfCFTA/EAC opportunities to develop Rwanda and wider African demand.
05	Deepen sustainability	Reduce leather waste through offcut accessories, responsible packaging and documented production practices.
06	Develop B2B & institutional sales	Target corporate gifting, executive accessories, events and selected institutional opportunities.

WETBLU BY MISSHIKS

Statement Leather Pieces

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BRAND PROMISE

Class • Function • African Heritage

Market ambition: Kenya → East Africa → Africa → Global